

Sky House Cleaning

New Employee Onboarding Packet

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New Hire Paperwork & Onboarding Checklist

Welcome to Sky House Cleaning — we're glad you're joining the team. Here's what to expect as a new employee, and what you'll need to get set up.

What It Means to Join Us as an Employee

You're joining Sky House Cleaning as a W-2 employee, not as an independent contractor. In practice, that means:

- We withhold taxes from your paycheck and handle the employer side of payroll taxes — you'll receive a W-2 at year-end, not a 1099.
- You're covered by workers' compensation insurance while you're on the job.
- You accrue paid sick leave under California law.
- You're paid at least California and local minimum wage, with overtime pay for anything over 8 hours in a day or 40 hours in a week, and required paid rest breaks and unpaid meal breaks built into your schedule.
- You'll be paid on a regular, set payday — not per job.

What to Bring on Day One

For your I-9 (federal work authorization form), bring **one** document from List A below, **or one from List B and one from List C**:

- **List A (either one, on its own):** U.S. Passport, or Permanent Resident Card
- **List B (identity):** Driver's license or state ID, or another government-issued photo ID
- **List C (work authorization):** Social Security card, or birth certificate

Documents need to be originals (or certified copies), not photocopies.

Paperwork You'll Complete

- ☐ **I-9** — Employment Eligibility Verification (we'll walk through this together on day one)
- ☐ **W-4** — federal tax withholding elections
- ☐ **DE 4** — California state tax withholding elections
- ☐ **Direct deposit form** (bring a voided check or your bank's routing/account number, or opt for paper checks)
- ☐ **Emergency contact information**
- ☐ **Signed acknowledgment** that you've received and reviewed the [Cleaning Standards Manual](#), [Service Checklists](#), [Approved Cleaning Supplies](#), and [Dress Code](#)
- ☐ **Wage Theft Prevention Act notice** — we'll provide this; it spells out your pay rate, payday, and other required details in writing
- ☐ **Paid sick leave notice** — we'll provide this; it covers how your sick leave accrues and how to use it

Your First Few Shifts

Your first few jobs will be a chance to walk through our standard together before you're working independently — expect some shadowing and hands-on feedback early on rather than being dropped into a job solo on day one. Take your time with the [Cleaning Standards Manual](#) and the checklist for whichever service types you'll be working — that's exactly what our clients expect every visit, and

it's what we'll be checking in on together as you settle in.

Questions?

Reach out any time — call or text (801) 759-2044 or email info@skyhousecleaning.com.

Employee Pay Structure

Pay for hourly (non-exempt) employees, scaling with experience and how consistently they meet our standard. These are starting suggestions — adjust as you get a feel for your team and market.

A Wage Floor to Build From

Oakland's local minimum wage is \$17.34/hr as of January 1, 2026 (above the CA state minimum of \$16.90/hr) — that's the floor for any hours worked within Oakland city limits. If your crews work in other Bay Area cities on a given day, check that city's local minimum too — several (San Francisco, Emeryville, and others) set their own rate above the state minimum, and the applicable rate is wherever the employee is physically working that day, not where your business is based.

Suggested Pay Tiers

Tier	Who this is	Suggested rate
New / Provisional	First few weeks, still learning our standard and checklists	\$18-\$21/hr
Experienced	Reliable, efficient, consistently meets the standard with little to no supervision	\$22-\$27/hr
Lead / Top-Tier	Multiple years of experience, can be trusted with our most demanding jobs, can train or lead others, near-zero callbacks	\$29-\$34/hr

A new hire typically starts at the bottom of the New/Provisional range and moves up as they build a track record — most employees would move to the Experienced tier within their first 30–60 days if they're consistently meeting the standard.

Building Overtime and Breaks Into the Math

As W-2 hourly employees, a few California rules aren't optional and need to be built into scheduling, not just payroll:

- **Overtime:** 1.5x their rate after 8 hours in a day or 40 hours in a week; 2x after 12 hours in a day.
- **Rest breaks:** a paid 10-minute break for every 4 hours worked — this is paid time, not a discount off the hourly total.
- **Meal breaks:** an unpaid 30-minute break required for any shift over 5 hours, and it needs to actually happen, not just be offered.

Practically: a job that runs long enough to trigger overtime costs 1.5x labor for those hours, and a route packed too tight to fit in breaks creates real liability (an extra hour of pay owed per missed break, per day). Worth factoring both into how big a home or job list you assign someone in a single day, not just into the pay rate itself.

A Few Other Things to Keep in Mind

- **Pay is for actual hours worked**, tracked with a real timekeeping method (a time-tracking app, punch clock, or similar) — California is strict about accurate time records for hourly employees.
- **Reliability matters as much as speed**. A steady employee who's a little slower but never misses a detail or a shift is worth more than one who's fast but inconsistent — factor that into tier placement, not just how quickly they finish.
- **Revisit this periodically**. As you get real data on job times and team performance, these ranges are worth revisiting rather than treating as fixed.

Cleaning Standards Manual

This is the standard we hold every visit to, no matter which service it is or who's on the job. Clients trust us because the quality is consistent every single time — that consistency is the whole reason Sky House Cleaning exists.

The Sky House Standard

- **Work top to bottom, back to front.** Dust and debris fall as you clean, so work high surfaces before low ones, and the back of a room before the areas you'll walk back through — that way you're never re-dirtying something you already finished.
- **No shortcuts on the details.** Check corners, baseboards, under furniture you can safely move, and behind items on counters — not just the open, obvious surfaces.
- **Glass and mirrors should be streak-free,** not just wiped. Take the extra minute.
- **Put things back exactly where you found them.** If you move something to clean under or around it, it goes back in its original spot.
- **Leave no trace you were there** — except a clean home. Take your trash out with you unless a client has asked you to empty theirs, and don't leave rags, bottles, or equipment behind.
- **If something's broken, missing, or looks off, say something.** Flag it to the client (or to us, if you're not comfortable raising it directly) before you leave — don't just clean around it and hope it's not noticed.
- **If you're not sure, ask — don't skip it.** A quick question is always better than guessing and getting it wrong.
- **Respect the home.** Shoes off or booties on if asked, no personal calls while you're working, keep personal items to a minimum, and make sure everything is locked up the way you found it when you leave.

What We Offer

Every service has its own detailed checklist — see [Service Checklists](#) for the full room-by-room breakdown of each one:

- **One-Time Cleaning** — a standard reset clean for the kitchen, bathrooms, living areas, and the whole home.
- **Recurring Cleaning** — the same standard clean, on a weekly, bi-weekly, or monthly schedule.
- **Deep Cleaning** — everything in a standard clean, plus interior cabinets, appliances, walls, baseboards, and interior windows.
- **Move-In / Move-Out Cleaning** — the same expanded scope as Deep Cleaning, for a home in transition.
- **Interior Car Detailing** — a full interior detail: seats, carpets, trunk, dash, console, and door panels.
- **Garage Cleaning & Organization** — decluttering, zone-based organizing, and a full clean of the space.
- **Office & Commercial Cleaning** — recurring janitorial cleaning for offices and small businesses.
- **Post-Construction Cleaning** — a rough clean followed by a final detailed clean for new builds, renovations, and remodels.
- **Airbnb Cleaning** — fast turnover cleaning between guests, so a listing is spotless and guest-ready every time.

Whatever the job, the standard above applies across all of them — the checklists tell you *what* to

clean; this page is about *how* we clean it.

Service Checklists

A room-by-room checklist for every service we offer. These match what's promised on the website, so completing every item is what "done" looks like on a Sky House Cleaning job.

One-Time & Recurring Cleaning

Kitchen

- ☐ Wipe down and spot-clean cabinet faces
- ☐ Clean the stovetop, burners, and drip pans
- ☐ Freshen the inside of the microwave
- ☐ Clean the exterior of appliances
- ☐ Polish the sink and wipe counters and backsplash

Bathrooms

- ☐ Thoroughly scrub sinks, toilets, tubs, and showers
- ☐ Polish faucets and mirrors
- ☐ Wipe counters and cabinet fronts

Living Areas & Bedrooms

- ☐ Tidy pillows, blankets, and common areas
- ☐ Make beds (if fresh linens are left out)
- ☐ Dust shelves and blinds
- ☐ Wipe window sills
- ☐ Clean the glass sliding door (if the home has one)

Throughout the Home

- ☐ Vacuum carpets and sweep/mop hard surfaces
- ☐ Dust interior shelves and closets
- ☐ Wipe down handrails

Deep Cleaning & Move-In / Move-Out Cleaning

Everything above, plus:

Kitchen

- ☐ Clean the interior of cabinets and drawers
- ☐ Clean the interior of appliances (oven, refrigerator, dishwasher)

Bathrooms

- ☐ Clean the interior of cabinets and drawers

Living Areas & Bedrooms

- ☐ Wipe down ceiling fans

Throughout the Home

- ☐ Wipe down walls and baseboards
- ☐ Clean interior windows
- ☐ Clean the glass sliding door

Garage Cleaning & Organization

Organization

- ☐ Sort and declutter items with the client's input (keep, donate, discard)
- ☐ Group items into zones that make sense for them (tools, sports gear, seasonal items, and more)
- ☐ Set up or improve shelving, bins, and storage systems
- ☐ Label bins and storage areas so it's easy to keep up

Cleaning

- ☐ Sweep and mop the garage floor
- ☐ Wipe down shelves, workbenches, and storage units
- ☐ Clear cobwebs and dust corners, rafters, and light fixtures
- ☐ Wipe down the interior of cabinets and storage bins

Interior Car Detailing

Interior Detailing

- ☐ Full vacuum of seats, carpets, and trunk
- ☐ Wipe down all interior surfaces, including the dash, console, and door panels
- ☐ Clean interior glass and mirrors
- ☐ Spot-treat stains on fabric seats and upholstery
- ☐ Wipe down leather and vinyl surfaces
- ☐ Clean cup holders, vents, and other tight spots

Office & Commercial Cleaning

General Cleaning

- ☐ Empty trash and replace liners
- ☐ Vacuum carpets and mop hard floors
- ☐ Dust desks, surfaces, and furniture
- ☐ Wipe down and disinfect high-touch surfaces (door handles, light switches, handrails)
- ☐ Clean interior glass, mirrors, and partitions

Restrooms, Break Rooms & Common Areas

- ☐ Clean and disinfect toilets, sinks, and countertops
- ☐ Restock paper towels, toilet paper, and soap when supplies are left on-site

- ☐ Wipe down break room counters, tables, and the exterior of appliances
- ☐ Empty and reline trash bins
- ☐ Wipe down reception desks and shared furniture near entrances

Post-Construction Cleaning

Rough Clean

- ☐ Remove construction debris, packaging, and leftover materials
- ☐ Sweep and vacuum up dust and debris from floors
- ☐ Wipe down dust from surfaces, sills, and ledges
- ☐ Clean windows and glass of construction dust, stickers, and labels

Final Clean

- ☐ Detailed cleaning of kitchens and bathrooms, including inside cabinets and drawers
- ☐ Wipe down all surfaces, baseboards, and trim
- ☐ Clean interior windows, tracks, and sills
- ☐ Vacuum carpets and mop hard floors
- ☐ Wipe down light fixtures and switch plates
- ☐ Remove any remaining dust, stickers, or residue

Airbnb Cleaning

Turnover Cleaning

- ☐ Full clean of the kitchen, bathrooms, bedrooms, and living areas between every guest
- ☐ Strip used linens and remake every bed with fresh ones
- ☐ Wash, dry, and restock towels
- ☐ Vacuum and mop all floors
- ☐ Take out trash and reset recycling

Guest-Ready Touches

- ☐ Restock guest essentials like toilet paper, paper towels, soap, and coffee
- ☐ Fluff pillows, straighten throws, and reset staged decor
- ☐ Wipe down and spot-check appliances
- ☐ Quick walkthrough to flag any damage, missing items, or maintenance issues
- ☐ Turn the space around fast between checkout and check-in

Approved Cleaning Supplies

We're picky about what goes into a client's home, and that applies no matter whose bottle it comes out of. Whether you're using supplies we provide or bringing your own, every product used on a Sky House Cleaning job needs to meet this standard:

- **EWG-rated for safety** — scores well with the Environmental Working Group, so there's nothing harsh or hidden in what's being used.
- **Eco-friendly, plant-based formulas** — biodegradable, made from plant-based or naturally occurring ingredients.
- **Vegan and cruelty-free** — nothing tested on animals or made with animal-derived ingredients.
- **Gentle, but still effective** — cuts through dirt, grime, and everyday buildup without harsh chemicals, and is safe to have around kids and pets.

If you're ever unsure whether a product meets this bar, check it against the [EWG Guide to Healthy Cleaning](#) before bringing it into a client's home, or reach out and we'll point you to our approved list.

What You'll Typically Need

- All-purpose surface cleaner
- Glass & mirror cleaner (streak-free, ammonia-free)
- Bathroom cleaner (for soap scum and hard water buildup)
- Kitchen degreaser
- Wood floor cleaner
- Microfiber cloths — ideally color-coded by area (e.g., one color for bathrooms, another for kitchens, another for general dusting) to avoid cross-contaminating surfaces between rooms
- Vacuum with a HEPA filter
- Mop and microfiber mop pads
- Rubber gloves
- Trash bags

Never bring bleach, ammonia-based cleaners, or anything with a harsh chemical odor into a client's home — if a job seems to call for something stronger than our standard allows, flag it to us rather than reaching for it yourself.

Dress Code

Simple and consistent: **all black.**

- Solid black top and bottom
- Closed-toe, non-slip shoes (you're on your feet on all kinds of floors, so this is as much about safety as it is looks)
- Clean and presentable — you're representing Sky House Cleaning in someone's home or business

If you'd like a Sky House Cleaning logo t-shirt, just ask — we're happy to provide one.